BUILDICY
BUILD THE FUTURE

SERVICE GUIDE

Product Engineering

Custom SaaS, business applications, and dedicated engineering partnerships.

Buildicy is a product and engineering partner for startup founders, agencies and operating businesses. We help define what should be built, build it, and hand it over in a form your team can run, change and extend.

We combine product engineering, AI automation and business-system thinking. We also develop our own AI-first products and internal tools alongside client work.

This guide describes proposed services and illustrative briefs. It does not describe completed client projects or promise specific outcomes.

> *"We don't just build software. We build the systems behind growth."*

Software built around your workflow.

Seven categories of work, each scoped to your situation. For each one, this section sets out a typical use case, what may be delivered, the questions that shape the scope, the intended outcome, and what it depends on. Deliverables are proposals to be agreed, not a fixed menu.

A SaaS and MVP Development

Typical use case	A founder has a defined problem and needs a first working product to put in front of users. SaaS (software as a service) is software delivered online, usually by subscription. An MVP (minimum viable product) is the smallest version that can test the idea.
Potential deliverables	Problem definition · Core workflows · User roles and permissions · Prioritised scope · Working web application · Launch foundations such as deployment and accounts
Key scoping questions	Who are the first users? · Which one workflow must work on day one? · What can wait for version two? · How will you know the MVP has done its job?
Intended outcome	A usable first version, with a written record of what was left out and why, ready to test with real users.
Dependencies	Founder decisions on priorities · Access to representative users · Brand, content and third-party accounts (for example payments or email)

B Custom Business Applications

Typical use case	A business runs an important process on spreadsheets, email and chat, and it is hard to track or audit.
Potential deliverables	Workflow mapping · Data model · Web application with accounts and roles · Notifications and approvals · Admin screens · Import of existing data
Key scoping questions	Who does what, and in what order? · Where does the data come from today? · Which steps need approval? · What reports are needed?
Intended outcome	A process that lives in one system, with clear ownership of each step.
Dependencies	Staff time to explain the current process · Sample data · Decisions on business rules · Hosting and account ownership

C Dashboards and Client Portals

Typical use case	Teams or customers keep asking for status, documents or figures that someone compiles by hand.
Potential deliverables	Role-based views · Reports and charts · Self-service pages for requests, documents and status · Login and controlled access · Connections to source systems · Data export
Key scoping questions	Who may see what? · Which figures matter, and how are they defined? · Where does the data live? · How current must it be?
Intended outcome	People find the information they need themselves, and each user sees only what they are permitted to see.
Dependencies	Reliable source data · Agreed metric definitions · Access to source systems · A list of users and roles

D Internal Tools and CRM/ERP Workflows

Typical use case	A team uses an off-the-shelf CRM or ERP but needs custom steps around it, or needs a small tool for an internal process. A CRM (customer relationship management system) tracks contacts and deals. An ERP (enterprise resource planning system) manages operations such as orders, inventory and finance.
Potential deliverables	Custom modules, such as an approval flow, intake form or quoting tool · Integrations with the system you already use · Reporting add-ons · User permissions · Data migration scripts where needed
Key scoping questions	What does your current system already do well? · Where is the gap? · Does it offer an API? · Who administers it?
Intended outcome	The gap is closed with a focused module. Not every project needs a complete ERP replacement; many need one well-chosen addition to systems that already work.
Dependencies	Admin access and an available API on your current system · Vendor plan and licence terms · Decisions on which system holds the master record

E APIs and Third-Party Integrations

Typical use case	Data is retyped between tools, or a product must connect to payment, messaging, accounting or CRM services. An API (application programming interface) is the way one software system talks to another.
Potential deliverables	Data-flow design · API connections · Permission and authentication set-up · Error handling and retries · Logs · Documentation of how data moves
Key scoping questions	Which system is the source of truth? · What data moves, in which direction and how often? · What happens when a connection fails? · Who holds the provider accounts?
Intended outcome	Data moves between systems in a defined way, and failures are visible rather than silent.
Dependencies	Provider API access, plan limits and fees · Test accounts and credentials · Provider rule changes, which Buildicy does not control

F AI-Enabled Product Features

Typical use case	A product or team has a defined task where a language model can help, such as answering questions from documents or drafting a first version. AI should solve a defined user problem, not be added for appearance. Sometimes the right answer is not to use AI.
Potential deliverables	Knowledge assistants that answer from approved sources · Document workflows, such as extracting, summarising or classifying · Copilots inside a product · Task automation · Test sets and review views
Key scoping questions	What user problem does it solve? · How will answer quality be judged? · What must it never do? · Where does a person review its output?
Intended outcome	An AI feature tied to a user problem, with its limits and human review defined. Model output can be wrong, so quality is tested and reviewed, not assumed.
Dependencies	Approved source content · Choice of AI provider and its usage charges · Data-handling decisions

G Maintenance and Feature Delivery

Typical use case	A live product needs upkeep and continuing development.
Potential deliverables	Bug fixes · Updates to software components · Monitoring, where included · Small enhancements · Roadmap work
Key scoping questions	What counts as a bug and what counts as a new feature? · How are requests raised and prioritised? · What support hours are expected? · Who has production access?
Intended outcome	The product keeps working and improves in agreed steps. Maintenance, monitoring and ongoing development are separately agreed services. They are not automatically part of a build.
Dependencies	Access to code and environments · An agreed support scope · Hosting and third-party accounts in good standing

03 · WHO WE PARTNER WITH

Three kinds of engagement.

Audience	What they typically bring	How Buildicy may work
Startup founders	A defined problem, an initial product, or the next stage of development.	Helps shape the scope, builds the first version, and continues with agreed iterations.
Agencies	Client projects that need engineering capacity or a technical delivery partner.	Dedicated or white-label delivery, where the commercial arrangement permits it.
Growing organisations	Operational needs that off-the-shelf tools do not fully meet.	Custom tools and integrations that connect to the systems already in use.

> **Capacity and availability.** This guide does not state delivery capacity, availability or staffing commitments. These are discussed and agreed for each engagement.

Seven stages, each with an approval point.

01 Discovery → 02 Definition → 03 Design → 04 Engineering → 05 QA → 06 Launch → 07 Iteration

Stage	Buildicy	You	Typical output	Approval point
Discovery	Learns about users, workflows, goals, constraints and success measures.	Shares context and gives access to users and existing tools.	Discovery summary.	You confirm the summary is accurate.
Definition	Turns findings into prioritised requirements, scope boundaries and assumptions.	Sets priorities and decides trade-offs.	Requirements and scope document.	Scope sign-off.
Design	Maps user journeys and wireframes, and proposes interface direction.	Reviews and gives consolidated feedback.	Journeys, wireframes, interface direction.	Design approval.
Engineering	Builds, integrates and reviews at milestones.	Answers questions and supplies accounts and content.	Working software increments.	Milestone reviews.
Quality Assurance	Runs functional tests, checks access rules and edge cases, and applies agreed checks.	Tests with real scenarios.	Test results and fixed-issue list.	Acceptance sign-off.
Launch	Deploys, configures environments and hands over.	Confirms readiness and holds the agreed accounts.	Live release and handover notes.	Release approval.
Iteration	Gathers feedback, supports prioritisation and maintains the product.	Gives feedback and makes roadmap decisions.	Prioritised backlog and updates.	Roadmap decisions.

Buildicy does not set fixed sprint lengths or guaranteed timelines in this guide. Timing depends on scope and on how quickly decisions and feedback arrive, and is set out in the proposal.

05 · ENGAGEMENT MODELS

Choosing how to work together.

The right model depends on how well defined the work is and how long it will run. Buildicy recommends one after discovery.

Model	When it fits	What must be agreed	How scope changes are handled
Defined-scope project	Requirements are clear and the work has a defined end.	Scope, deliverables, milestones, acceptance criteria and payment terms.	A change request is described, assessed for effort and impact, and approved in writing before work begins.
Discovery engagement	There is a need or idea, but the requirements are not yet clear.	The questions to answer, who takes part, and the outputs, such as a scope document or wireframes.	Questions can be reprioritised by agreement. The outputs may feed a later proposal.
Focused MVP or pilot	You want to test a product or workflow with a limited scope.	The single core workflow, the user group, the boundaries, the success measures, and what happens afterwards.	Additions are weighed against what would be removed. Larger additions become a new scope.
Dedicated engineering partnership	Development is continuing, for a startup, an agency or an operating team.	The working arrangement, how priorities are set, communication, commercial terms, and any white-label rules.	Priorities change through the agreed process. Commercial changes are agreed in writing.
Maintenance and iteration retainer	A live product needs upkeep and gradual improvement.	Included services, how requests are raised, support hours and escalation, and what is billed separately.	Requests outside the agreed scope are quoted or scheduled separately.

Prices are not stated in this guide and are set out in the proposal after discovery. Revision rounds are defined in the proposal. Revisions are not unlimited.

06 · ENGINEERING PRINCIPLES

How we approach the build.

These are principles Buildicy proposes to work by. They are not certifications, and each is applied to the scope that is agreed.

Principle	What it means in practice
Clear requirements	What is being built, for whom, and what is excluded, written down before building starts.
Maintainable implementation	Structured, readable code that another engineer can pick up and change.
Appropriate architecture	The simplest structure that fits the expected use, without building for scale that may never arrive.
Access control	Users see and do only what their role allows, and administrator access is limited.
Testing	Functional tests and agreed checks before release, as defined in the quality assurance stage.
Documentation	Handover notes on how the product is set up, run and changed.
Observability, where included	The ability to see what the system is doing and why it failed, through logs, error reports and basic monitoring.
Cost awareness	Recurring costs, such as hosting, APIs and AI usage, are made visible before they are committed.
Practical handover	Your team knows what exists, where it is, who owns it and how to run it.

What “scalable” means here. A scalable product is designed to grow in an agreed way, with more users, more data or more features, without being rebuilt. It does not mean unlimited. Performance targets depend on expected load, testing, infrastructure and budget, and are agreed in the proposal.

Technology choices. No technology stack is listed in this guide. Choices follow discovery, based on your requirements, your existing systems and your team’s ability to maintain the product.

07 · OWNERSHIP, ACCESS AND SUPPORT

Agree these before work begins.

The points below should be written into the proposal and contract. Raising them early avoids disagreements later.

Topic	What to agree
Source-code ownership and transfer	Who owns the delivered code, when ownership transfers, and in what form it is handed over.
Existing Buildicy intellectual property	Reusable components, tools and know-how that Buildicy already has, and whether you receive a licence to use them.
Third-party and open-source licences	Which licences apply to included components, and what obligations they bring.
Repository access	Where the code is hosted, who can access it, and when you receive access.
Domain and hosting ownership	Whose name the accounts are in, and how they transfer.
Production credentials	Who holds keys and passwords, how they are shared, and how they are changed.
Deployment responsibilities	Who deploys releases, who approves them, and who responds if a release fails.
Documentation	What handover documentation is delivered.
Warranty or bug-fix period, if offered	Whether there is one, how long it lasts, and what it covers and excludes.
Ongoing maintenance	Whether it is included, and on what terms.
Support hours and escalation	When support is available, how issues are raised, and who to escalate to.
Third-party recurring costs	Hosting, APIs, messaging, AI usage and licences: who pays, and who holds each account.
Change requests	How changes are requested, estimated, approved and recorded.

> **Ownership is not assumed.** Who owns what depends on the contract terms and payment conditions that are agreed. Nothing in this guide means that intellectual property transfers automatically. You may wish to have a legal adviser review the contract.

Three example briefs.

> **These are illustrative briefs.** They are not completed projects or case studies, and they describe no results. Real scope depends on discovery.

A An early-stage SaaS MVP

Business situation	A founder wants to test a tool for one defined group of users, built around a single core workflow.
Proposed scope	User accounts · Two or three roles, such as admin, member and viewer · One core workflow, end to end · A basic admin screen · Deployment · Payment integration, only if in scope
Discovery questions	Which role matters most? · What is the single workflow? · What can wait? · How do users sign up?
Dependencies	Priority decisions · Payment and email provider accounts · Domain and branding
Example acceptance criteria	A user in each role can complete the core workflow without help · Role permissions block actions outside a user's role · Agreed test cases pass · Known issues are listed

B An agency client portal

Business situation	An agency manages client requests and approvals through email and chat, and compiles reports by hand.
Proposed scope	Client login · Request submission and status · Approval of deliverables, with a record · Shared files · A reporting view from agreed sources · An agency admin view · White-label branding, if permitted
Discovery questions	What should each client see? · What approval steps exist? · Where does report data live? · Does the commercial arrangement permit white-label branding?
Dependencies	Access to reporting data · Client list · Brand assets · Hosting
Example acceptance criteria	A client sees only their own requests and files · Approvals record who approved and when · The report view matches the source on an agreed sample · An admin can add a client without developer help

C An operations dashboard

Business situation	An operations lead collects figures each week from a CRM, a spreadsheet and an accounting tool.
Proposed scope	Connections to the named tools through their APIs or exports · Agreed metric definitions · A dashboard with role-based views · Scheduled data refresh · Alerts when a connection fails
Discovery questions	Which figures matter, and how are they defined? · Which tool is the source of truth? · How current must the data be? · What should happen if a source is unavailable?
Dependencies	API access and plan limits · Credentials · Metric definitions
Example acceptance criteria	Each agreed metric matches its source on a reviewed sample · Users see only the views their role allows · If a source fails, the dashboard shows the data as out of date rather than showing wrong numbers silently

Our work

No approved project details are included in this guide. Buildicy's portfolio is at **portfolio.buildicy.com**.

Discovery checklist

- ☐ **What are you building?**
- ☐ **Who will use it?**
- ☐ **What is the most important workflow?**
- ☐ **What already exists?**
- ☐ **What are the constraints?**
- ☐ **Who approves scope?**
- ☐ **What outcome would make the project worthwhile?**

NEXT STEP

Tell us what you're building. Let's define the right next step.

Email **buildicy@gmail.com** to arrange a discovery call.

Website buildicy.com **Portfolio** portfolio.buildicy.com

Contracting and invoicing details are confirmed in the project proposal.